

Running the portal



CF Building Approvals — office admin guide (/admin)

Sign in at the portal address + /admin with the staff passcode · Updated August 2026

THE ADMIN FRONT PAGE, TOP TO BOTTOM

1 Sync health banner

Green = last sync ran inside the hour, all good. **Amber "stale"** = no sync for over an hour — check the incident card. **Red "failed"** = the error is printed in the banner. Below it, any **unmatched Monday clients** are listed: those cards' jobs and messages reach nobody until matched. Fix each with the dropdown ("add as alias to...") or *New client* — one click, done on the next sync.

2 Portal pages (the on/off switches)

Turn a client section off while you update it — the link vanishes, the page shows "temporarily unavailable", and the matching actions pause. Flip it back when done. No deploy needed; takes effect on next page load.

3 Info sheets & Council forms

Upload a PDF to **supersede a guidance note** (clients get the new version instantly; Revert restores the original), or to host the current **BA1/BA2/BA5/BA13/BA19/BA22** under Resources. When the Building Commission revises a form, replacing it here takes ten seconds.

4 Submission queue (usually empty)

Lodgements go straight onto the board. A lodgement only waits here if Monday couldn't be reached when it was submitted — Accept sends it on. If the queue keeps filling, Monday or its token is the problem.

5 Run sync

Forces the 5-minute cycle to run now — useful when a client's on the phone. The result line shows jobs, files, messages and anything unmatched.

CLIENTS & LOGINS

- ✓ **Add a client** — name as it appears in Monday's Client column (suffixes and brackets are ignored automatically); their email if the board carries it — an email match attaches jobs regardless of spelling; other spellings as aliases.
- ✓ **Issue a login** — username plus an optional **person's name** (their messages then show "Joe, Ventura Homes"). The one-time setup code appears once — pass it on straight away; it expires in 30 days.
- ✓ **"I can't log in"** — click their username to **reset**: a new setup code is issued and their old password keeps working until they use it. Clients can also self-serve with *Forgot password?* — a code goes to the email we hold.
- ✓ **Check folders** — per client, confirms the portal can resolve their SharePoint Issued folders.

REPORTS AND THE ACTIVITY LOG

- ✓ **Reports** — issued counts, the *actual* median turnaround in business days against the 3–4 we publish, and busiest clients. If the median creeps above the published figure, either the process or the promise needs adjusting — the page flags it.
- ✓ **Activity log** — the append-only record: accepts, rejects, logins issued/reset, client matches, certificate downloads (with who). This is what a complaint, insurer or Building Services Board query asks for — it fills itself.

THE MESSAGES RULES — WORTH KNOWING COLD

- ✓ An update starting `FIR:` or `CLIENT:` goes to the client — portal thread *and* email. **Anything else stays internal.** Never start an internal note with either prefix.
- ✓ Works on a card in any active status; completed/cancelled cards aren't scanned.
- ✓ When a client replies, the office gets an email — you never need to watch the board for replies.
- ✓ Files you attach to a Monday update do *not* reach the client — put requests in words. (Sending documents to clients is a future feature.)

SWITCHES THAT LIVE IN VERCEL (NOT /ADMIN)

<code>AUTO_ACCEPT_LODGEMENTS</code>	Default on. Set <code>0</code> to make every lodgement wait in the review queue for a human Accept.
<code>DIGEST_ENABLED</code>	Default off. Set <code>1</code> to send every builder a Monday-morning summary of their active jobs, with a "with you" section that chases FIRs automatically.
<code>RETENTION_MONTHS</code>	How long downloaded packages stay before the files purge. Currently 3 .
<code>OFFICE_EMAIL</code>	Where client-reply notifications land. Keep it a watched inbox.

Changing a Vercel variable does nothing until the project is **redeployed** — Deployments → ⋮ → Redeploy.

WEEKLY TWO-MINUTE SWEEP

- Sync banner green?
- Unmatched list empty — or matched with one click?
- Submission queue empty?
- Reports: median turnaround still inside the published 3–4 days?
- Any new Monday status labels created this week? Tell Chris so the portal's wording map stays complete.

The two calendar reminders that matter: the Microsoft Graph client secret (expires ~July 2028 — six weeks' warning is set; an expired secret silently stops files, folders and email) and the Monday API token if its owner's account ever changes.